

Software Requirements

1.1 Purpose

This document outlines the functional requirements for a custom, web-based platform designed to support the organization's mentorship programs, event management, and community outreach efforts. The primary objective is to replace manual processes (such as relying on Google Drive and basic spreadsheets) with an automated, user-friendly digital system. The platform will make it easy for community members to find mentors and register for events, while keeping ongoing operational and software costs minimal.

1.2 User Roles

- General users
- Admin (Operations Team)
- Mentors
- Mentees
- Volunteers

Functional Requirements

1. General Users (Visitors)

- **FR1:** The platform shall allow any general user to browse organization information, view upcoming events, and search the mentor directory without logging in.
- **FR2:** The platform shall allow general users to create an account and gain immediate access to the system without requiring prior administrative approval.
- **FR3:** The platform shall allow general users to search and filter mentor profiles by industry, career specialization, skills, location, and real-time availability.
- **FR4:** The platform, once signed in, shall display individual mentor profiles containing biography, professional background, skills, languages, availability status, and a direct booking link.
- **FR5:** The platform shall allow general users to register for events.
- **FR6:** The platform shall send automated event registering confirmations and email reminders to general users prior to registration events.
- **FR7:** The platform shall allow general users to register for events by submitting their full name, email address, phone number, current profession, interest in mentorship/volunteering, and preferred event types.
- **FR8:** The platform shall automatically close event registrations once a predefined maximum registration limit or seat capacity is reached.
- **FR9:** The platform shall allow general users to apply to become a mentor by submitting an online form containing personal details, professional history, resume, LinkedIn profile, references, and supporting documents.

2. Operations Team (Admin)

- **FR10:** The platform shall allow the Operations Team to securely log in and access an administrative dashboard.
- **FR11:** The platform shall allow the Operations Team to manage users accounts or their own.
- **FR12:** The platform shall allow the Operations Team to create, edit, publish, and archive events.
- **FR13:** The platform shall allow the Operations Team to view event registrations, attendee lists, and export registration data.
- **FR14:** The platform shall allow the Operations Team to review mentor applications, request additional information, perform background checks where required, and approve or reject applications.
- **FR15:** The platform shall allow the Operations Team to activate, deactivate, and monitor mentor accounts and participation.
- **FR16:** The platform shall allow the Operations Team to view, manage, suspend, or remove mentee accounts and monitor their participation.
- **FR17:** The platform shall allow the Operations Team to view and manage upcoming, completed, and cancelled mentoring sessions.
- **FR18:** The platform shall allow the Operations Team to update website content, announcements, FAQs, mentorship program information, resume review sessions, mock interview sessions, and career guidance content.
- **FR19:** The platform shall provide the Operations Team with dashboards and reports displaying mentor activity, mentee activity, mentoring sessions, event registrations, mentor applications, and community growth metrics.
- **FR20:** The platform shall allow the Operations Team to manage automated notifications for registrations, confirmations, reminders, approvals, onboarding, application status updates, missed sessions, and upcoming events.
- **FR21:** The platform shall allow the Operations Team to manage mentor and mentee accounts, reset user accounts, and assign or revoke administrative privileges where multiple administrators exist.

3. Mentors

- **FR22:** The platform shall require mentors to review and accept the Mentoring Toolkit guidelines via an online checkbox agreement prior to completing a mentor application or scheduling a session.
- **FR23:** The platform shall allow mentors to set, update, and manage their general and recurring availability schedules, including setting weekly or monthly mentorship hour limits.
- **FR24:** The platform shall allow mentors to block out specific dates or time slots when they are unavailable for mentoring sessions.
- **FR25:** The platform shall allow mentors to accept or decline incoming mentoring requests from mentees.

- **FR26:** The platform shall allow mentors to view and manage their upcoming mentoring sessions and track their historical mentorship record.
- **FR27:** The platform shall display individual performance and operational metrics directly on each mentor's personal profile page, including total mentorship hours, completed sessions, and missed appointments.
- **FR28:** The platform shall sync scheduled mentoring sessions with mentors' external calendars, specifically supporting Google Calendar and Microsoft Outlook.
- **FR29:** The platform shall send automated alerts to mentors who have not updated their availability calendar within a configurable timeframe.
- **FR30:** The platform shall allow active mentors to update their listed areas of specialization, skills, and personal contact details at any time.

4. Mentees

- **FR31:** The platform shall allow mentees to register, log in, and accept the mentorship compliance agreement during sign-up.
- **FR32:** The platform shall allow mentees to create, update, and maintain their profile.
- **FR33:** The platform shall allow mentees to search mentors by expertise, industry, skills, or domain.
- **FR34:** The platform shall display mentors' available time slots and allow mentees to book only those published by mentors.
- **FR35:** The platform shall send booking confirmations and reminder notifications to mentees.
- **FR36:** The platform shall allow mentees to view upcoming and previous mentoring sessions.
- **FR37:** The platform shall allow mentees to cancel or reschedule mentoring sessions in accordance with the organization's policy.
- **FR38:** The platform shall allow mentees to submit feedback after completed mentoring sessions.

5. Volunteers

- **FR39:** The platform shall allow general users to apply for or sign up as operational and marketing volunteers.
- **FR40:** The platform shall allow active volunteers to transition into or register for mentee/mentorship roles directly within the system.
- **FR41:** Volunteers are allowed to expand their outreach activities aimed at recruiting new mentees and raising group awareness.
- **FR42:** The platform shall provide volunteers to assist staff with event setup, attendee tracking, and platform administration.
- **FR43:** The platform shall allow volunteers to view assigned task lists, marketing drives, and community outreach campaigns assigned by the administrative team.

Non-Functional Requirements

- **NFR1: Cost:** The platform shall minimize licensing and operational costs by using open-source or low-cost technologies where appropriate.
- **NFR2: Usability:** The platform shall provide a simple, intuitive, mobile-responsive, and self-service user interface for all the users.
- **NFR3: Security:** The platform shall provide secure authentication, role-based access control, and collect and store only the user data necessary for the operation of the mentorship platform.
- **NFR4: Performance:** The platform shall provide fast and reliable performance for event registration, mentor search, and mentoring session scheduling.
- **NFR5: Scalability:** The platform shall support future growth in users, mentors, mentees, events, and mentoring sessions without significant changes to the system architecture.